

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in one variable	Easy

Question

John paid a total of **\$165** for a microscope by making a down payment of **\$37** plus ***p*** monthly payments of **\$16** each. Which of the following equations represents this situation?

Answer

- A. $16p - 37 = 165$
- B. $37p - 16 = 165$
- C. $16p + 37 = 165$
- D. $37p + 16 = 165$

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is correct. It's given that John made a **\$16** payment each month for ***p*** months. The total amount of these payments can be represented by the expression **$16p$** . The down payment can be added to that amount to find the total amount John paid, yielding the expression **$16p + 37$** . It's given that John paid a total of **\$165**. Therefore, the expression for the total amount John paid can be set equal to that amount, yielding the equation **$16p + 37 = 165$** .

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.